

Solve problems involving addition and subtraction of fractions using knowledge of equivalent fractions

Learning intention

- solve problems involving addition and subtraction of fractions using knowledge of equivalent fractions.

Teach and model

- calculating the addition or subtraction of fractions in the context of realistic problems.
- representing addition and subtraction of fractions, using an understanding of equivalent fractions and methods such as jumps on a number line.
- understanding the processes for adding and subtracting fractions with related denominators and fractions as an operator, in preparation for calculating with all fractions.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

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Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.